

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 17: India, a Home to Many

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	17 — India, a Home to Many
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic P3 traps: assuming a community came to TRADE when it actually fled persecution (or was brought enslaved, like the Siddis); collapsing Islam's peaceful 7th-century arrival through Arab merchants into the much later military invasions; confusing 'refuge/opportunity', 'immigrate/emigrate', 'cosmopolitan/pluralism/tolerance/ethos'; assuming integration meant losing one's identity (it did not — synagogues, fire temples, churches and languages were kept); and treating diversity as a weakness when the chapter presents it as a source of strength, in the spirit of vasudhaiva kutumbakam. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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1. A speaker argues that India should keep out all foreigners 'to protect its culture'. Which value from this chapter most directly contradicts that argument?
- (A) vasudhaiva kutumbakam — 'the whole world is one family'
 - (B) the recognition of certain communities as scheduled tribes
 - (C) the principle that a guest must repay hospitality with trade
 - (D) the rule that newcomers must abandon their own faith
2. 'Atithi devo bhava' and 'vasudhaiva kutumbakam' are best described as, respectively:
- (A) a value of hospitality toward the guest, and a broader value treating the whole world as one family
 - (B) a trade slogan, and a rule of warfare
 - (C) a value about one God, and a value about many gods
 - (D) a Zoroastrian prayer, and a Jewish prayer

3. The chapter presents India's long history of receiving newcomers chiefly as evidence that:

- (A) its guiding ethos has been one of acceptance, welcoming many communities over thousands of years
- (B) India was repeatedly conquered and ruled by every group that arrived
- (C) India remained closed and only opened to outsiders in modern times
- (D) only one community has ever lived in India

4. If we say India has historically been a 'cosmopolitan' civilisation, we mean it has:

- (A) welcomed only wealthy traders and turned away the poor
- (B) absorbed newcomers by erasing their original cultures
- (C) stayed loyal to a single culture above all others
- (D) been at home with people of many cultures, like 'a citizen of the world'

5. A student claims, 'India's openness is just an ancient idea with no use today.' Using the chapter, the best rebuttal is that vasudhaiva kutumbakam:

- (A) was abandoned once the ancient period ended
- (B) has universal relevance for today's world, where many peoples must live together
- (C) applies only to relations between traders
- (D) means India must rule over the whole world as one family

6. Two newcomers arrive in India: one is fleeing religious persecution at home, the other is chasing profit in the spice trade. The chapter would classify these two motives, in order, as:

- (A) opportunity and refuge
- (B) refuge and opportunity
- (C) conquest and trade
- (D) asylum and persecution

7. Which of these communities was the EXCEPTION to the rule that newcomers came either for refuge or for opportunity — because it came by neither free choice?

- (A) the Parsis, who fled persecution
- (B) the Armenians, who came to trade
- (C) the Tibetans, who fled danger
- (D) the Siddis, who were brought enslaved

8. Grouping by motive, which set of three communities ALL came to India seeking refuge from persecution or danger?

- (A) the Arab merchants, the Armenians, and the Siddis
- (B) the Parsis, the Arab merchants, and the Tibetans
- (C) the Parsis, the Tibetans, and the Jews
- (D) the Jews, the Armenians, and the Siddis

9. A refugee and an ordinary immigrant both settle in India. The clearest difference the chapter draws is that the refugee:

- (A) is the only one who is allowed to keep any traditions
- (B) comes freely, attracted by trade and opportunity
- (C) is driven out by danger or persecution and has little real choice
- (D) can never become part of Indian society

10. 'To emigrate' and 'to immigrate' differ in direction. A Tibetan who leaves Tibet and settles in India has, in these terms:

- (A) immigrated from Tibet and emigrated to India
- (B) only emigrated, since one cannot do both at once
- (C) neither, because a refugee does not migrate
- (D) emigrated from Tibet and immigrated to India

11. Which pairing correctly matches a community to its single best-fitting motive as given in the chapter?

- (A) Parsis — opportunity through trade
- (B) Siddis — refuge from persecution
- (C) Tibetans — opportunity through trade
- (D) Arab merchants — opportunity through trade

12. The Bene Israel and the Cochin Jews are best described as:

- (A) two African-origin communities brought enslaved to India
- (B) the Kerala Muslim community formed by Arab settlers
- (C) two of India's Jewish communities, who built synagogues and kept their faith here
- (D) followers of Zoroastrianism who settled in Gujarat

13. A synagogue, a fire temple, a church and a mosque appear in the chapter. Which statement correctly links a building to its community?

- (A) the synagogue belongs to the Parsis and the fire temple to the Jews
- (B) the synagogue belongs to the Jews and the fire temple to the Parsis
- (C) the church belongs to the Siddis and the mosque to the Tibetans
- (D) the fire temple belongs to the Arab merchants and the mosque to the Parsis

14. That the Jews of India could build synagogues and keep their faith for centuries is the chapter's evidence for a broader claim about how India received newcomers. That claim is:

- (A) newcomers integrated into Indian society while keeping their own identities
- (B) newcomers had to give up their religion to be accepted
- (C) newcomers stayed completely apart and never joined Indian society
- (D) newcomers were allowed to rule over the older inhabitants

15. Of the Jews, the Parsis and the Arab merchants, which one did NOT come to India seeking refuge?

- (A) the Jews
- (B) the Parsis
- (C) the Arab merchants
- (D) all three came seeking refuge

16. The Syriac Christians are distinctive because they show that Christianity in India:

- (A) arrived only in the 20th century with European rule
- (B) is very old, with one of the world's oldest Christian communities settled in Kerala
- (C) was brought to India by enslaved African communities
- (D) is practised only by people of Armenian origin

17. What do the Syriac Christians of Kerala and the Jews of India most clearly have in common, according to the chapter?

- (A) both are ancient communities that preserved their faith while becoming part of Indian society
- (B) both were brought to India enslaved and later freed
- (C) both came chiefly as conquering armies
- (D) both abandoned their original religion after settling

18. If asked to place the Syriac Christians on the 'refuge vs opportunity' map alongside the Parsis, the safest reasoning is that:

- (A) unlike the Parsis, they came to conquer Kerala
- (B) unlike the Parsis, they gave up their religion on arrival
- (C) like the Parsis, they are an old community that settled and preserved its faith in India, fitting the pattern of newcomers who kept their identity
- (D) like the Arab merchants, they were brought to India enslaved

19. Zoroastrianism, the faith of the Parsis, is best summed up as:

- (A) a recent religion founded in India, worshipping many gods of nature
- (B) one of the world's oldest religions, worshipping one God, Ahura Mazda, and stressing the choice of good over evil
- (C) a branch of Judaism centred on the synagogue
- (D) a Tibetan healing tradition now part of AYUSH

20. A student writes that 'Zarathushtra is the god the Parsis worship.' The correct statement is that Zarathushtra was:

- (A) the human prophet who founded Zoroastrianism, while the one God worshipped is Ahura Mazda
- (B) the one God of Zoroastrianism, while Ahura Mazda was the prophet
- (C) an Arab merchant who built India's oldest mosque
- (D) the maharaja who sheltered the Polish children

21. The Parsis settling in Gujarat, keeping their fire temples, best illustrates which combination of ideas from the chapter?

- (A) a trading community that came for opportunity and then ruled Gujarat
- (B) an enslaved community later recognised as a scheduled tribe
- (C) a modern community that arrived only in the 20th century
- (D) a refugee community that integrated into Indian society while preserving its identity

22. Both the Parsis and the Jews fled persecution, yet they settled in different parts of India. The chapter associates the Parsis mainly with _____ and the Jews with their _____.

- | | |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Gujarat; synagogues | (B) Kerala; fire temples |
| (C) Tibet; monasteries | (D) Armenia; churches |

23. Why does the chapter use the Parsis as a strong counterexample to the claim 'all communities came to India to trade'?

- (A) because the Parsis came to conquer and rule Gujarat
- (B) because the Parsis were brought to India enslaved
- (C) because the Parsis refused to settle permanently in India
- (D) because the Parsis came not to trade but to find refuge from religious persecution

24. Which statement about the AGE of the religions linked to India's newcomer communities is correct?

- (A) Zoroastrianism is the newest of the world's religions
- (B) Christianity reached Kerala only in modern times
- (C) Zoroastrianism is described as one of the world's oldest religions
- (D) Islam reached India's west coast only after the later invasions

25. The most accurate account of how Islam FIRST reached India is that it:

- (A) came only through the much later military invasions
- (B) never actually reached India until the 20th century
- (C) was brought by enslaved Siddis from Africa
- (D) came peacefully with Arab merchants on the west coast from the 7th century

26. The chapter treats 'Islam came peacefully with Arab traders' and 'Islam came through later invasions' as:

- (A) the same single event described in two ways
- (B) two separate events, the peaceful trading arrival coming centuries earlier
- (C) proof that religions spread only by conquest
- (D) evidence that Islam never spread by trade anywhere

27. India's oldest mosque, on the west coast, is significant in the chapter because it is physical evidence that:

- (A) Arab merchants conquered the west coast by force
- (B) the Siddis built places of worship after being freed
- (C) Islam arrived early and peacefully through Arab merchants, not only through later invasions
- (D) the Parsis adopted Islam soon after reaching Gujarat

28. The Mappila community of Kerala came into being when:

- (A) Tibetan refugees were given shelter in the 1950s
- (B) African people were brought to India enslaved
- (C) Polish children were sheltered during a war
- (D) Arab merchants settled on the coast and married into local families

29. A student says, 'The Arab merchants and the Mappila prove every newcomer came by force.' The best correction is that they actually prove:

- (A) religions and communities spread only through conquest
- (B) trade never leads to lasting communities
- (C) the Arab merchants were brought to India enslaved
- (D) a community can form peacefully through trade and settlement, not only by force

30. Comparing the Mappila and the Siddis on how their communities began, the key difference is that the Mappila:

- (A) were brought enslaved, while the Siddis were free traders
- (B) and the Siddis both began as conquering armies
- (C) arose from free traders who settled and married locally, while the Siddis were brought enslaved
- (D) and the Siddis both fled religious persecution

31. Of all the communities in the chapter, the Siddis are unique chiefly because they:

- (A) are the only community that kept its original religion
- (B) were brought to India enslaved rather than coming by choice for refuge or trade
- (C) are the only community recognised as having an ancient faith
- (D) were the only traders who married into local families

32. The Siddis are of _____ origin and were brought to India _____ between roughly the 7th and 19th centuries.

- | | |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------|
| (A) Tibetan; as refugees | (B) Armenian; as traders |
| (C) African; enslaved | (D) Polish; as wartime children |

33. Today the Siddis are recognised in India as a scheduled tribe. This means they are:

- (A) a community officially recognised by the Constitution for special support and protection
- (B) a community banned from settling in India
- (C) a foreign trading guild with special tax rights
- (D) a ruling dynasty with power over a state

34. From enslaved arrival to constitutional recognition as a scheduled tribe, the Siddi story best illustrates that India:

- (A) only ever welcomed wealthy traders and rulers
- (B) drew even a community brought enslaved into the protections of Indian society over time
- (C) expelled communities that arrived without choosing to
- (D) kept enslaved communities permanently outside society

35. The Armenians and the Arab merchants are alike in the chapter because both communities:

- (A) fled religious persecution as refugees
- (B) were brought to India enslaved
- (C) came to India seeking opportunity through trade and settled here

(D) arrived as 20th-century war refugees

36. The Armenians built churches in India while trading and settling. This best supports the claim that newcomers who came for opportunity:

- (A) always gave up their religion in exchange for trading rights
- (B) still kept their own faith and identity while becoming part of Indian society
- (C) never put down lasting roots in India
- (D) came only to conquer the regions they traded in

37. The Baha'is are included in the chapter mainly to show that India's tradition of acceptance:

- (A) ended once the ancient communities had arrived
- (B) was extended only to communities that came to trade
- (C) continued into modern times and was offered across different faiths
- (D) applied to a single religion alone

38. Which two communities together best show that India offered refuge and acceptance NOT only in ancient times but also in modern times?

- (A) the Baha'is and the Tibetan refugees
- (B) the Jews and the Syriac Christians
- (C) the Parsis and the Arab merchants
- (D) the Siddis and the Armenians

39. The 'Good Maharaja' is remembered in the chapter for an act that best exemplifies which value?

- (A) building India's oldest mosque for Arab traders
- (B) founding Zoroastrianism for the Parsis
- (C) giving refuge to those fleeing danger — sheltering Polish children during a war
- (D) recognising the Siddis as a scheduled tribe

40. The Polish children sheltered by the 'Good Maharaja' should be classified as:

- (A) traders who came seeking opportunity
- (B) an enslaved community brought against their will
- (C) refugees who fled the dangers of war
- (D) the original inhabitants of the region

41. The story of the 'Good Maharaja' and the Polish children connects most directly to which other example in the chapter?

- (A) the Tibetan refugees, since both are cases of giving shelter to people fleeing danger
- (B) the Arab merchants, since both came for trade
- (C) the Siddis, since both were brought enslaved
- (D) the Armenians, since both built churches

42. The Tibetan refugees are described as fleeing danger and being given shelter in India. Which single label best captures their arrival?

- (A) refuge
- (B) opportunity
- (C) conquest
- (D) enslavement

- 43.** Sowa Rigpa, the Tibetan 'Art of Healing', is significant in the chapter because it:
- (A) became part of India's AYUSH programme, showing newcomers enriched India's knowledge
 - (B) replaced India's older systems of medicine entirely
 - (C) was kept strictly secret within the Tibetan community
 - (D) was abandoned by the Tibetans once they reached India
- 44.** That Tibetan medicine joined India's AYUSH programme is used in the chapter to refute which misconception?
- (A) that India ever sheltered refugees at all
 - (B) that welcoming refugees adds nothing to, or even weakens, the host culture
 - (C) that Sowa Rigpa is a religion rather than a medical system
 - (D) that the Tibetans came to India to trade
- 45.** The Tibetan refugees and their Sowa Rigpa together best illustrate the combined idea that:
- (A) India admitted only traders who brought profitable goods
 - (B) refugees must give up their knowledge to be accepted
 - (C) India gave refuge to a people fleeing danger, and that people then enriched Indian knowledge
 - (D) newcomers always weaken the culture that receives them
- 46.** In the chapter's vocabulary, 'persecution' is best understood as:
- (A) a warm welcome extended to newcomers
 - (B) a formal agreement to trade between communities
 - (C) shelter offered to those fleeing danger
 - (D) hostility and ill-treatment, often on religious, ethnic, social or political grounds
- 47.** 'Refuge' (or asylum) and 'persecution' are linked but opposite in the refugee's story. Which statement keeps them in the right relationship?
- (A) people flee persecution and seek refuge
 - (B) people flee refuge and seek persecution
 - (C) refuge and persecution mean the same thing
 - (D) persecution is the shelter a refugee is given
- 48.** Describing India as a 'pluralist' society, in this chapter's sense, means it features:
- (A) the rule of one dominant community over all the others
 - (B) the gradual removal of its smaller minority communities
 - (C) a single shared religion that everyone must follow
 - (D) the peaceful coexistence of many communities, faiths and cultures in one society
- 49.** A people's 'ethos', as the word is used in the chapter, refers to their:
- (A) characteristic spirit or guiding values — here, acceptance and openness
 - (B) traditional system of medicine
 - (C) main place of worship

(D) principal goods of trade

50. 'Tolerance' and 'pluralism' are related ideas in the chapter. The best way to distinguish them is that tolerance is more about the _____, while pluralism is more about the _____.

- (A) rejection of newcomers; rule of one community over others
- (B) attitude of accepting and respecting different beliefs; condition of many communities coexisting in one society
- (C) system of medicine; place of worship
- (D) act of leaving a country; act of entering a country

51. Match each term to its meaning: 'cosmopolitan', 'tolerance', 'ethos'. The correct set is:

- (A) cosmopolitan = a people's guiding spirit; tolerance = at home with many cultures; ethos = respecting different beliefs
- (B) cosmopolitan = respecting different beliefs; tolerance = a people's guiding spirit; ethos = at home with many cultures
- (C) cosmopolitan = a system of medicine; tolerance = a place of worship; ethos = a trade good
- (D) cosmopolitan = at home with many cultures; tolerance = respecting different beliefs; ethos = a people's guiding spirit

52. A newcomer says, 'I had to leave my homeland and enter India.' Using migration vocabulary precisely, the correct description is that the person:

- (A) immigrated from the homeland and emigrated into India
- (B) did neither, because leaving and entering cancel out
- (C) was persecuted, which is the same as having immigrated
- (D) emigrated from the homeland and immigrated into India

53. A student argues, 'Because refugees built synagogues, fire temples and churches of their own, they must have stayed apart and never really joined Indian society.' The best correction is that keeping their own places of worship actually shows:

- (A) they refused to settle and soon left India
- (B) they gave up their faiths to fit into Indian society
- (C) they ruled over the older inhabitants of India
- (D) they integrated into Indian society while keeping their own identities

54. Which statement best captures the BALANCE the chapter strikes about how newcomers fit into India?

- (A) they fully assimilated, abandoning every trace of their origins
- (B) they neither stayed wholly apart nor dissolved entirely — they integrated while keeping their identities
- (C) they stayed completely separate, never mixing with Indian society
- (D) they took control of India and imposed their own ways

55. The clearest single piece of evidence in the chapter that newcomers kept their identities is that they:

- (A) were each given their own separate territory to rule
- (B) maintained distinct places of worship and languages while living within Indian society
- (C) all adopted a single common religion and language
- (D) left India whenever their own customs were questioned

56. A claim states, 'Welcoming so many communities must have weakened India's culture.' The chapter answers that diversity, on the contrary:

- (A) enriched Indian culture by adding foods, words, crafts, music and faiths
- (B) stripped away the older parts of Indian culture
- (C) left Indian culture exactly as it had always been
- (D) made all of India's communities culturally identical

57. Borrowed foods, words, crafts and music in everyday Indian life are offered in the chapter as concrete proof that:

- (A) a culture is destroyed whenever outsiders contribute to it
- (B) the mixing of many communities makes a culture richer, not poorer
- (C) outside contributions leave a culture completely unchanged
- (D) only trade goods, not culture, ever crossed into India

58. Taken as a whole, the chapter's verdict on India's diversity of communities is that it is:

- (A) a weakness that left India vulnerable
- (B) a problem best solved by removing minorities
- (C) a matter of no real importance to India
- (D) a source of strength and richness, in the spirit of vasudhaiva kutumbakam

59. Consider four communities — the Jews, the Arab merchants, the Siddis and the Tibetans. Which statement correctly sorts ALL of them by how they came to India?

- (A) all four came for opportunity through trade
- (B) Jews and Arab merchants came for refuge; Siddis and Tibetans for opportunity
- (C) Jews and Tibetans came for refuge, Arab merchants for opportunity, and the Siddis were brought enslaved
- (D) Siddis and Tibetans came for refuge; Jews and Arab merchants were enslaved

60. A student summarises the chapter in one line: 'Everyone came to India to trade, refugees lost their identities, and all this diversity weakened the culture.' How many of the three claims are correct, and what is the best overall correction?

- (A) all three are correct as stated
- (B) none are correct — many came as refugees or enslaved, communities kept their identities, and diversity enriched the culture

(C) only the 'lost their identities' claim is correct

(D) only the 'diversity weakened the culture' claim is correct

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 17: India, a Home to Many — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	D	21	D	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	C	22	A	32	C	42	A	52	D
3	A	13	B	23	D	33	A	43	A	53	D
4	D	14	A	24	C	34	B	44	B	54	B
5	B	15	C	25	D	35	C	45	C	55	B
6	B	16	B	26	B	36	B	46	D	56	A
7	D	17	A	27	C	37	C	47	A	57	B
8	C	18	C	28	D	38	A	48	D	58	D
9	C	19	B	29	D	39	C	49	A	59	C
10	D	20	A	30	C	40	C	50	B	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) The chapter's central value, *vasudhaiva kutumbakam* ('the whole world is one family'), holds that India treats outsiders as kin, the direct opposite of keeping all foreigners out. Scheduled-tribe recognition is about constitutional support for groups already here, not about admitting outsiders. The chapter never says a guest must repay hospitality with trade — *atithi devo bhava* is unconditional. And the chapter shows newcomers kept their faiths, so demanding they abandon them would contradict, not support, India's actual tradition.

2. (A) '*Atithi devo bhava*' ('a guest is like God') is specifically about hospitality to the guest, while '*vasudhaiva kutumbakam*' ('the whole world is one family') is the wider civilisational ideal that frames all of humanity as kin. Neither is a trade slogan or rule of warfare. Neither is a statement about the number of gods worshipped. And neither is a prayer of the Parsis or Jews — they are India's own guiding values, the ethos of acceptance the chapter is built around.

3. (A) The point of the chapter is that India's ethos — its characteristic spirit — has long been acceptance, so it became home to many communities over millennia. It is not a story of every newcomer conquering and ruling India; most came as traders or refugees. India was not closed until modern times — Arab merchants arrived as early as the 7th century and Jews even earlier. And the whole chapter refutes the idea that only one community ever lived here.

4. (D) 'Cosmopolitan' means at home with many cultures — 'a citizen of the world' — exactly the openness the chapter describes. It is not selective by wealth: India sheltered refugees and even enslaved-origin communities, not just rich traders. It does not mean erasing newcomers' cultures — the chapter stresses they kept their identities. And it is the opposite of clinging to a single culture; that would be the closed attitude the chapter argues against.

5. (B) The chapter explicitly presents *vasudhaiva kutumbakam* as having universal relevance for the modern world, where diverse peoples increasingly share the planet — modern examples like the Tibetan refugees and the Baha'is prove the ethos continued. It was not abandoned after antiquity. It is not limited to traders; refugees were welcomed too. And 'one family' means kinship and acceptance, not India ruling the world.

6. (B) The chapter names two paths: refuge (fleeing persecution or danger) and opportunity (seeking trade or a better life). The first newcomer flees persecution — that is refuge; the second chases trade profit — that is opportunity. The reverse order is wrong. 'Conquest' is not one of the chapter's two paths. And 'asylum and persecution' confuses the shelter (asylum/refuge) with the very thing being fled (persecution).

7. (D) The Siddis are the exception: they were brought to India enslaved, not by their own choice for refuge or opportunity. The Parsis chose refuge from persecution, the Armenians chose opportunity through trade, and the Tibetans chose refuge from danger — all three made a choice, even if a hard one. Only the enslaved Siddis fit neither voluntary path, which is exactly why the 'everyone came to trade' claim is false.

8. (C) The Parsis, the Tibetans, and the Jews all came seeking refuge (the Parsis and Jews fled persecution; the Tibetans fled danger). The Arab merchants and Armenians came for opportunity (trade), and the Siddis were brought enslaved — so any group containing them is not an all-refugee set. Distinguishing refuge from opportunity, and remembering the enslaved Siddis, is the key skill here.

9. (C) The chapter contrasts the refugee — pushed out by danger or persecution, with little choice — against those who come freely for opportunity. Keeping traditions was open to all newcomers, not refugees alone, so that is not the distinguishing feature. Coming freely for trade describes the opportunity-seeker, not the refugee. And refugees did become part of Indian society (Tibetans, Parsis, Jews), so exclusion is false.

10. (D) To emigrate is to leave a country and to immigrate is to enter one, so a Tibetan leaving Tibet emigrates from Tibet and, settling in India, immigrates to India — both, viewed from the two countries. Swapping the two reverses the directions. One movement of a person is naturally both an emigration (from the old land) and an immigration (to the new). And a refugee is precisely a kind of migrant, so 'does not migrate' is wrong.

11. (D) Arab merchants came for opportunity through trade — the correct match. The Parsis came for refuge from persecution, not trade. The Siddis did not come freely for refuge; they were brought enslaved. The Tibetans came for refuge from danger, not for trade. Each wrong pair swaps a refugee or enslaved community into the 'trade' slot, the chapter's most common trap.

12. (C) The Bene Israel and the Cochin Jews are Jewish communities of India who preserved their faith and built synagogues. They are not African-origin enslaved people — that describes the Siddis. They are not the Mappila, the Kerala Muslims formed when Arab merchants married locally. And they are not Zoroastrians — that is the Parsis of Gujarat. The names point specifically to India's Jews.

13. (B) A synagogue is the Jewish house of worship and a fire temple is the Zoroastrian (Parsi) one — the correct linkage. Reversing them mismatches both. The Syriac Christians, not the Siddis, are tied to churches, and the mosque is linked to Arab Muslims, not the Tibetans. And it was the Arab merchants who built India's oldest mosque, while the fire temple is Parsi — so the last pairing is doubly wrong.

14. (A) Surviving synagogues and an unbroken faith show identity-preserving integration: the Jews became part of Indian society yet kept their religion. This refutes the idea that acceptance required giving up one's religion. It also refutes total separation — they were part of Indian life, not apart from it. And it has nothing to do with newcomers ruling the older inhabitants; the point is coexistence, not domination.

15. (C) The Arab merchants came for opportunity through trade, not refuge — the odd one out. The Jews and the Parsis both fled persecution and so came for refuge. Because the Arab merchants are clearly the opportunity-seekers, 'all three came seeking refuge' is false. The question rewards separating the trade newcomers from the refugees.

16. (B) The Syriac Christians of Kerala are among the oldest Christian communities anywhere, showing Christianity's roots in India are ancient. They did not first arrive in the 20th century. They were not introduced by the African-origin Siddis. And while the Armenians were also Christians who came to trade, the Syriac Christians are a distinct, much older Kerala community — Christianity in India is not limited to people of Armenian origin.

17. (A) Both the Syriac Christians and the Jews are ancient communities that kept their own faith while integrating into Indian society — the model of identity-preserving

integration. Neither was brought enslaved (that was the Siddis). Neither came as a conquering army; the chapter's communities mostly came for refuge or trade. And neither abandoned its religion — the very point is that they kept it.

18. (C) The chapter groups the Syriac Christians with communities like the Parsis and Jews that settled in India and preserved their faith — identity-preserving integration. They did not conquer Kerala. They did not give up their religion; preserving it is precisely the point. And they were not enslaved — that was the Siddis, and the Arab merchants came freely as traders, so that comparison fails twice over.

19. (B) Zoroastrianism is among the world's oldest religions; it worships one God, Ahura Mazda, and emphasises choosing good over evil. It is neither recent nor Indian-founded nor polytheistic. It is not a branch of Judaism — the synagogue is the Jewish house of worship, not the Zoroastrian fire temple. And it is not a healing tradition; that confuses it with Sowa Rigpa, the Tibetan 'Art of Healing'.

20. (A) Zarathushtra was the prophet who founded Zoroastrianism; the God worshipped is Ahura Mazda. Swapping the two names — making Zarathushtra the god and Ahura Mazda the prophet — is the exact error to avoid. Zarathushtra was not an Arab merchant who built a mosque, nor the 'Good Maharaja' of the Polish-children story; both are entirely different figures from other parts of the chapter.

21. (D) The Parsis fled persecution (refuge) and settled in Gujarat, keeping their fire temples and faith — refuge plus identity-preserving integration, a precise double match. They did not come for trade or rule Gujarat. They were not enslaved or made a scheduled tribe — that describes the Siddis. And they are an ancient arrival, not a 20th-century one like the Tibetan refugees.

22. (A) The Parsis settled mainly in Gujarat, and the Jews are associated with their synagogues. Kerala is tied to the Syriac Christians and fire temples are Zoroastrian (Parsi), so that pair mismatches both. Tibet and monasteries belong to the Tibetan refugees, and Armenia and churches to the Armenians — neither pair fits the Parsis or Jews.

23. (D) The Parsis came for refuge from persecution, not to trade, which directly breaks the 'everyone came to trade' claim. They did not come to conquer or rule Gujarat. They were not enslaved — that was the Siddis. And far from refusing to settle, they settled permanently and kept their fire temples, becoming a lasting part of Indian society.

24. (C) The chapter calls Zoroastrianism one of the world's oldest religions. It is not the newest. The Syriac Christians show Christianity reached Kerala in ancient times, not only recently. And Islam reached India's west coast peacefully through Arab merchants from the 7th century — well before, not after, the later military invasions. Three options misdate the arrival of a faith.

25. (D) Islam first reached India peacefully through Arab merchants trading on the west coast from the 7th century — separate from, and earlier than, the later military invasions. It did not arrive only by those invasions; that is the very misconception the chapter corrects. It did not first arrive in the 20th century. And it was not brought by the Siddis, who are an African-origin community with a different history.

26. (B) The chapter is careful to separate the peaceful 7th-century arrival via Arab traders from the much later military invasions — two distinct events, the trading arrival being far earlier. They are not one event. The peaceful arrival actually disproves the idea that religions spread only by conquest. And it shows Islam did spread by trade, contradicting any claim that it never spread peacefully.

27. (C) India's oldest mosque, built where Arab merchants settled, is concrete proof that Islam came early and peacefully by trade, not only by the later invasions. It was not the product of conquest by Arab merchants. It was not built by the Siddis, who are a separate African-origin community. And the Parsis kept Zoroastrianism — they did not adopt Islam, so that option is simply false.

28. (D) The Mappila are the Kerala Muslim community that formed as Arab merchants settled and married locally — opportunity-driven trade leading to a lasting community. The Tibetan-refugee shelter, the enslaved African Siddis, and the Polish-children rescue are all separate stories in the chapter and describe entirely different communities and circumstances.

29. (D) The Arab merchants who settled and the Mappila community that grew from them show a community forming peacefully through trade and intermarriage — the opposite of 'by force'. So they disprove the idea that communities spread only by conquest. They also show trade can create lasting communities. And the Arab merchants came freely for opportunity; they were not enslaved like the Siddis.

30. (C) The Mappila formed from free Arab traders who settled and married locally, whereas the Siddis were brought to India enslaved — a fundamental difference in choice and circumstance. Reversing the two (Mappila enslaved, Siddis free) is wrong. Neither community began as a conquering army. And neither is described as fleeing religious persecution — that motive fits the Parsis and Jews, not these two.

31. (B) The Siddis stand out because they were brought enslaved — not by free choice for refuge or opportunity like the others. Keeping one's original religion was true of many communities (Jews, Parsis, Christians), so that is not unique. Having an ancient faith fits the Zoroastrians and others too. And marrying into local families describes the Arab merchants/Mappila, not the enslaved Siddis.

32. (C) The Siddis are of African origin and were brought to India enslaved over a long span from about the 7th to the 19th centuries. They are not Tibetan refugees, not

Armenian traders, and not the Polish children sheltered during the war — each of those is a separate community with a different origin and a different reason for being in India.

33. (A) A scheduled tribe is a community the Indian Constitution recognises for special support and protection, which is the Siddis' modern status. It is not a ban on settling — the recognition assumes they are citizens deserving help. It is not a foreign trading guild; the Siddis are an Indian community of African descent. And it confers protective support, not ruling power over a state.

34. (B) The Siddis began enslaved yet are now a scheduled tribe with constitutional protection — showing India eventually drew even an involuntarily-brought community into the protections of society. This contradicts the idea that only wealthy traders were welcome. It contradicts expelling the involuntarily-arrived. And it contradicts keeping enslaved communities permanently outside — the opposite happened.

35. (C) Both the Armenians and the Arab merchants came for opportunity through trade and settled in India — the Armenians even building churches. Neither fled persecution as refugees (that fits the Parsis, Jews and Tibetans). Neither was brought enslaved (the Siddis). And neither arrived as 20th-century war refugees — that describes the Polish children and the Tibetans, not these traders.

36. (B) The Armenians traded and settled yet built churches — showing that even opportunity-seekers kept their faith and identity while joining Indian society, the same pattern as the refugee communities. They did not trade away their religion. Building churches shows lasting roots, not the absence of them. And trading and settling is the opposite of conquering the regions they traded in.

37. (C) The Baha'is, who also came seeking refuge and acceptance, show India's openness continuing into modern times and reaching diverse faiths. So acceptance did not end with the ancient communities. It was not limited to traders — the Baha'is and Tibetans were not traders. And it was not confined to one religion; the whole chapter spans Jews, Christians, Zoroastrians, Muslims, Baha'is and more.

38. (A) The Baha'is and the Tibetan refugees are the modern examples of India's continuing acceptance and refuge. The Jews and Syriac Christians are ancient communities. The Parsis (ancient refuge) and Arab merchants (early trade) are also old arrivals. The Siddis' enslavement spanned earlier centuries and the Armenians were earlier traders — none of these pairs makes the 'modern times' point as clearly as the Baha'is and Tibetans.

39. (C) The 'Good Maharaja' sheltered Polish children fleeing the dangers of war — a clear example of giving refuge to those in danger. He did not build India's oldest mosque (that was the Arab merchants). He did not found Zoroastrianism (that was the prophet

Zarathushtra, long before). And recognising the Siddis as a scheduled tribe is a modern constitutional act, not the Maharaja's deed.

40. (C) The Polish children were refugees fleeing the dangers of war, given shelter by the Maharaja. They were not traders seeking opportunity; they sought safety, not profit. They were not brought enslaved like the Siddis — they were sheltered out of compassion. And they were certainly not original inhabitants; they came from far away during wartime.

41. (A) Both the Polish children and the Tibetan refugees are cases of India sheltering people fleeing danger — the same value of refuge. The Arab merchants came for trade, an opportunity case, so the link there fails. The Siddis were enslaved, a different kind of arrival entirely. And the Armenians' church-building is about trade and identity, not about giving refuge.

42. (A) The Tibetans fled danger and were sheltered — that is refuge. It is not 'opportunity', which the chapter reserves for those who came freely for trade. It is not 'conquest'; they came as refugees, not an army. And it is not 'enslavement', the involuntary path that describes the Siddis. The Tibetans are a clear refuge case.

43. (A) Sowa Rigpa, the Tibetan system of medicine, became part of India's AYUSH programme — showing how a refugee community enriched Indian knowledge. It did not replace India's older medical systems; it was added alongside them. It was not kept secret — being included in AYUSH means it was shared. And it was not abandoned; it was preserved and recognised nationally.

44. (B) Sowa Rigpa entering AYUSH proves refugees can enrich the host culture, refuting the idea that they add nothing or weaken it. The chapter affirms — not denies — that India sheltered refugees, so that is not the misconception being corrected. The point is not to clarify whether Sowa Rigpa is a religion (it is a medical system). And the Tibetans came for refuge, not trade, so that is a separate matter.

45. (C) The Tibetans were given refuge (fleeing danger) and then contributed Sowa Rigpa to India's medicine — refuge plus cultural enrichment, a two-part match. India did not admit only profitable traders; it sheltered refugees who brought no trade goods. Refugees did not have to surrender their knowledge — they shared it through AYUSH. And the example shows enrichment, not the weakening the last option claims.

46. (D) Persecution is hostility and ill-treatment, often for religious or other reasons — exactly what many refugees fled. It is not a welcome; that would be the opposite. It is not a trade agreement. And it is not shelter offered to the endangered — that is refuge or asylum, which is what persecuted people seek, not the persecution itself.

47. (A) A refugee flees persecution (ill-treatment) and seeks refuge (shelter) — the correct cause-and-response. Reversing them — fleeing shelter to seek ill-treatment — makes no sense. They are opposites, not synonyms. And persecution is the danger fled, not the

shelter given; calling persecution 'the shelter' confuses the two ends of the refugee's journey.

48. (D) Pluralism is the peaceful coexistence of many communities, faiths and cultures together — what India displays. It is not the rule of one community over the rest; that would be domination, not pluralism. It is not the removal of minorities; pluralism preserves them. And it is not enforcing one shared religion; pluralism means many faiths living side by side.

49. (A) Ethos means the characteristic spirit or guiding values of a people — for India, the spirit of acceptance the chapter describes. It is not a system of medicine (that suggests Sowa Rigpa). It is not a place of worship (synagogue, mosque, fire temple, church). And it is not trade goods. Ethos is about values, not buildings, healing, or commerce.

50. (B) Tolerance is the attitude of accepting and respecting beliefs different from one's own, while pluralism is the social condition of many communities actually coexisting together — an attitude versus a state of society. They are not about rejection or domination; both are positive. They have nothing to do with medicine or worship. And leaving/entering a country is emigrate/immigrate, an unrelated pair.

51. (D) Cosmopolitan means at home with many cultures ('a citizen of the world'); tolerance means accepting and respecting different beliefs; and ethos means a people's guiding spirit or values. The other orderings shuffle these three definitions onto the wrong words. The last option assigns medicine, worship and trade — none of which matches any of the three social terms.

52. (D) Leaving the homeland is emigrating and entering India is immigrating, so the person emigrated from home and immigrated to India. The reversed pairing mislabels both directions. The two actions do not cancel out — a single move is naturally both an emigration and an immigration. And persecution (ill-treatment) is not a synonym for immigration; it may be the reason for leaving, but it is a different concept.

53. (D) Building synagogues, fire temples and churches while becoming part of Indian life is exactly identity-preserving integration — keeping their identities did not mean staying apart. It does not show they refused to settle; the buildings prove lasting settlement. It is the opposite of giving up their faiths. And it has nothing to do with ruling the older inhabitants; coexistence, not domination, is the theme.

54. (B) The chapter's balanced position is identity-preserving integration: newcomers joined Indian society yet kept their faiths, languages and customs — neither total assimilation nor total separation. Full assimilation (losing all origins) overshoots one way. Complete separation overshoots the other. And taking control of India misreads coexistence as conquest. The middle path is the chapter's actual claim.

55. (B) The surviving synagogues, fire temples, churches and languages are the chapter's clearest proof that newcomers kept their identities while living within Indian society. They were not handed separate territories to rule. They did not adopt one common religion and language — that would be losing their identities. And they did not leave whenever questioned; they settled permanently, keeping their distinct ways.

56. (A) The chapter argues diversity enriched Indian culture — adding foods, words, crafts, music and faiths — directly refuting the 'weakened' claim. It did not strip away older culture; it added to it. It did not leave culture unchanged; it visibly broadened it. And it did not make communities identical; the whole point is that distinct communities coexisted, keeping their differences while contributing.

57. (B) Everyday borrowed foods, words, crafts and music are evidence that mixing communities enriches a culture rather than impoverishing it. It does not destroy the culture — these contributions became part of Indian life. It does not leave culture unchanged — the borrowings are visible changes. And it shows far more than trade goods crossed into India: language, cuisine, crafts and music did too.

58. (D) The chapter's overall verdict is that diversity is a source of strength and richness, in keeping with *vasudhaiva kutumbakam*. It is not a weakness that left India vulnerable — the evidence shows enrichment. It is not a problem to be solved by removing minorities; pluralism preserves them. And it is certainly not unimportant — diversity is the chapter's central, valued theme.

59. (C) The Jews and Tibetans fled persecution or danger (refuge), the Arab merchants came freely to trade (opportunity), and the Siddis were brought enslaved — the only fully correct sort. 'All four for trade' ignores the refugees and the enslaved Siddis. Calling the Arab merchants refugees and the Tibetans opportunity-seekers mislabels both. And labelling the Jews and Arab merchants as enslaved is plainly false — that path belongs only to the Siddis.

60. (B) All three claims are wrong, so the correct count is none. Not everyone came to trade — Parsis, Jews and Tibetans fled persecution or danger, and the Siddis were brought enslaved. Refugees did not lose their identities — they kept synagogues, fire temples, churches and languages. And diversity did not weaken the culture — it enriched it with foods, words, crafts, music and faiths. Each surviving 'only this one is correct' option still endorses a refuted misconception.